

DreamRiver SaaS Roadmap

Inspired by Mike Hill's 10-Step Playbook
"I Built 3 SaaS Apps to \$200K MRR: Here's My Exact Playbook"

Mike Hill bootstrapped 5 SaaS apps (Curator.io, Frill.co, Juno.co, and more) to \$200K+ MRR without funding, using a repeatable framework. This roadmap maps his playbook to DreamRiver's current stage and next moves.

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At a Glance

Phase	Mike's Step	DreamRiver Status
1	Pick an Idea (proven market)	Done
2	Define MVP	Done
3	Build & Ship (charge day 1)	In Progress
4	Engage Customers (feedback)	Upcoming
5	Content & SEO	Upcoming
6	Private Lifetime Deal	Upcoming
7	AppSumo Launch	Future
8	Final LTD Push	Future
9	Reviews & Social Proof	Future
10	Reddit & Community	Future

Phase 1: Pick an Idea

Mike's Playbook

Pick an idea that has been done before. Choosing an existing business model validates that a market exists and people are willing to pay. Analyze competitors to understand what features customers want most. Build something that *cannot fail* — not something novel.

DreamRiver — Done

Dream journaling apps exist (DreamApp, DreamMoods, Dreamboard). The market is validated. DreamRiver's differentiation is the faith-based/biblical analysis angle — a proven niche (Pray.com, Abide, Hallow have raised hundreds of millions). We're in a "red ocean" with a clear wedge: biblical dream interpretation powered by AI.

Phase 2: Define MVP

Mike's Playbook

Determine what "good enough" looks like. The bar for MVPs is higher today — it needs to be polished enough that people will pay from day one. Study competitors' core features and build only what matters.

DreamRiver — Done

Core MVP is live: dream text input with AI analysis (OpenAI), biblical references and verse integration, AI-generated dream imagery (FLUX model), dream gallery with search, reading level customization (4 tiers), admin prompt editing, and Supabase auth.

Phase 3: Build & Ship

Mike's Playbook

Build the MVP swiftly. Critically: **charge from day one**. Don't give away free accounts — even early adopters should pay (via lifetime deal). This filters for serious users who give better feedback.

DreamRiver — In Progress

The app is deployed on Vercel and functional. Current priorities before charging:

- Stabilize core UX (modal scroll, image loading, analysis updates)
 - Onboarding flow for first-time users
 - Stripe payment integration (subscriptions + LTD)
 - Landing page polish with clear value prop and CTA
 - Terms of Service / Privacy Policy finalization
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Phase 4: Engage Customers

Mike's Playbook

Actively seek feedback from paying users. This is the most crucial development stage — your early adopters tell you what to build next. Talk to every single customer.

DreamRiver — Upcoming

Once we have paying users:

- In-app feedback (thumbs up/down on each analysis)
 - Email onboarding sequence (Welcome → Day 3 → Day 7 → Day 14)
 - Personal outreach to every early LTD buyer
 - Feature request board (consider Frill.co — Mike's own product!)
 - Dream quality scoring to improve AI prompts
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Phase 5: Content & SEO

Mike's Playbook

Start writing content *immediately* — it's never too early. Write landing pages, "Alternative to [Competitor]" pages, blog posts. The longer content is live, the sooner Google and AI tools (ChatGPT, Perplexity) index it.

DreamRiver — Upcoming

High-priority content to create:

- "Alternative to" pages: DreamRiver vs DreamApp, vs DreamMoods
 - SEO posts: "What does the Bible say about dreams?", "Biblical dream symbols"
 - Feature landing pages for each core capability
 - Add /blog section (MDX or CMS-backed)
 - Google Search Console + analytics setup
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Phase 6: Private Lifetime Deal

Mike's Playbook

Run a private LTD to raise early revenue. Typical pricing: \$59-\$100 one-time for lifetime access. Promote in Facebook groups, LTD communities, and on X/Twitter. Frill raised ~\$30K from this phase alone.

DreamRiver — Upcoming

Plan the LTD launch:

- Tier 1 (~\$49): 30 dreams/mo, standard reading levels
 - Tier 2 (~\$79): Unlimited dreams, all reading levels, priority analysis
 - Tier 3 (~\$129): Everything + early access + family sharing (future)
 - Target: Christian Facebook groups, LTD communities, r/Christianity
 - Lead magnet: "Free Guide to Biblical Dream Symbols"
 - Revenue target: \$10-30K for 6-12 months of runway
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Phase 7: AppSumo Launch

Mike's Playbook

AppSumo has massive reach. Two options: Marketplace (lower fee, self-serve) or Select (sales team, higher visibility, 60-70% fee). Use for reach and user acquisition.

DreamRiver — Future

Prepare for AppSumo (~3-6 months out):

- AppSumo listing: screenshots, demo video, feature comparison
 - Infrastructure scaling plan (Vercel, Supabase, OpenAI rate limits)
 - AppSumo-specific tier: 1-3 stackable codes at \$39-\$79/code
 - Support FAQ and workflow for high-volume questions
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Phase 8: Final LTD Push

Mike's Playbook

Run a final private LTD at slightly higher prices. "Last chance" before recurring-only pricing. Creates urgency. Then close the LTD window forever.

DreamRiver — Future

After AppSumo:

- "Last chance" email campaign (72-hour countdown)
 - Bump LTD tiers by 30-50%
 - Transition to subscriptions: Free (3 dreams/mo), Pro (\$9.99/mo), Family (\$19.99/mo)
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Phase 9: Reviews & Social Proof

Mike's Playbook

Get LTD customers to write honest reviews on Trustpilot, G2, Capterra. Reviews boost domain ranking and credibility. Make it easy for happy customers to share.

DreamRiver — Future

Once 50+ paying users:

- Trustpilot profile + review widget on landing page
 - In-app review prompt after 10th dream analysis
 - Testimonial collection via email
 - Case studies: "How [User] deepened their prayer life with DreamRiver"
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Phase 10: Reddit & Community

Mike's Playbook

Answer questions honestly on Reddit and Quora. Listen to competitor complaints. Help people. Provide genuine value and mention your product only when relevant.

DreamRiver — Future

Ongoing engagement:

- Monitor: r/Dreams, r/Christianity, r/Bible, r/DreamInterpretation
 - Quora: biblical dream interpretation, dream journaling topics
 - Value-first approach: answer questions, mention DreamRiver naturally
 - Track competitor complaints — build those fixes
 - Consider DreamRiver Discord community for power users
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Financial Milestones

Milestone	Target	Mike's Benchmark
First paying customer	Month 1-2 of LTD	Immediate (LTD launch)
\$1K MRR	Month 3-4	~Month 2-3
\$5K MRR	Month 6-8	~Month 4-6
\$10K MRR	Month 9-12	~Month 6-9
\$50K MRR	Year 2	~Year 1-2
Sustainable (covers costs + salary)	\$5-10K MRR	—

Mike's key insight: "Monitor your burn rate. As LTD revenue depletes, your MRR must be growing fast enough to sustain operations. If not, cut costs — don't raise prices on existing customers."

DreamRiver's Competitive Advantages

- **Faith-based niche** — No major AI dream app targets Christians specifically
- **Biblical integration** — Verse references, reading levels tuned to spiritual maturity
- **AI-generated imagery** — Visual dream representations (most competitors are text-only)
- **Privacy-first** — Dreams are deeply personal; we don't share or train on user data
- **Customizable analysis depth** — 4 reading levels from accessible to seminary-level

Immediate Next Steps (This Week)

1. Fix UX bugs flagged in testing (modal scroll, image loading, analysis refresh) — Done
2. Set up Stripe integration for payments
3. Design LTD tier pricing
4. Begin writing first 3 SEO blog posts
5. Polish landing page with clear CTA and value proposition

Roadmap based on Mike Hill's playbook. Video: youtube.com/watch?v=67zh8_yiPh4